

How to Bring a Petition to God

At the beginning of the service, at the beginning of prayer, this kept coming up in my spirit: "I want protocol tonight. I want protocol."

Hallelujah.

"Yes, I want you to lead them back into it. Lead them back in tonight. I want protocol."

I said, "Yes, sir."

Have you ever tried to teach something when He was not helping you? Maybe once or twice.

Amen.

Open to Matthew 6. You can be seated, and let us prepare ourselves to petition God for the lost and to pray for this next year coming in. We will begin in Matthew 6, and then we will probably go over to John 16 for a few moments.

Thank You, Jesus.

Let us reiterate and get ourselves ready, beginning with Matthew 6:5:

And when thou prayest, thou shalt not be as the hypocrites are:
for they love to pray standing in the synagogues and in the corners of the streets,
that they may be seen of men.
Verily I say unto you, They have their reward.

In other words, if there were nobody to watch them, there would not be any prayer.

Jesus says:

But thou, when thou prayest, enter into thy closet,
and when thou hast shut thy door,
pray to thy Father which is in secret;
and thy Father which seeth in secret shall reward thee openly.

Then He says:

But when ye pray, use not vain repetitions, as the heathen do:
for they think that they shall be heard for their much speaking.

Of course, He is talking about paganism, chanting, and those kinds of things that cause them to become possessed.

Verse 8 says:

Be not ye therefore like unto them:
for your Father knoweth what things ye have need of, before ye ask him.

Tonight we are going to approach the Godhead with a petition. For just a few moments, we are going to study the proper way to approach Him. As I walk toward the Godhead with a petition, I need to know what role each member of the Godhead takes in that petition.

He said your heavenly Father already knows what you have need of before you pray. Actually, from the foundation of the world, you are not going to have something in your petition that you can sneak up on Him with.

Many times, as I meditated through this passage, I wondered, "If He already knows what is in my heart or in my petition before I pray, then what use is the ceremony of going through the prayer? If He already knows what I have need of before I open my mouth, why does He not just do it?"

He says He knows what you have need of before you pray, and then He says something absolutely incredible in verse 9:

After this manner therefore pray ye:
Our Father which art in heaven, Hallowed be thy name.

One more time, what did Kenneth Hagin say? When you see the word therefore, you had better see what it is there for. Therefore means, "In conclusion to, or based on, what I have already said, I am about to say this."

This is what Jesus has already said: He already knows what is in your petition, and yet you are still approaching Him. Therefore, pray this way. That means if He already knows what is in your petition, then what He is about to list are prerequisites that cause the prayer in your petition to be answered. If these things are not in your life, there is no use bringing Him the petition.

The first way we enter the Father's presence to present our petition is worship:

Hallowed be thy name.

Holy is Your name.

It was right here, studying prayer, that Jesus spoke to me and said, "Did you know that the same instructions for entering the Father's presence are the same instructions you use to enter into My presence?"

Go to John 16 for a moment. I feel this prayer coming so strongly that I know He is pacing me, and I do not have very long.

John 16:13 says:

Howbeit when he, the Spirit of truth, is come,
he will guide you into all truth:
for he shall not speak of himself;
but whatsoever he shall hear, that shall he speak:
and he will shew you things to come.

Verse 14:

He shall glorify me:
for he shall receive of mine, and shall shew it unto you.

It was here that I found out it was the Holy Spirit who brings me into the presence of Jesus. But then again, it is Jesus who brings me into the presence of the Father.

What is the ministry of the Holy Spirit on the inside of me? To glorify Jesus. Therefore, it is the ministry of the Holy Spirit to bring me into the presence of Jesus. Yet it is the ministry of Jesus to bring me into the presence of the Father.

The more I meditated on this, the more excited I became because I wanted to know more about approaching the Godhead with a petition. What is the role of the Holy Spirit? What is the role of Jesus? What is the role of the Father?

One more time: it is the Holy Spirit who brings me into the presence of Jesus, and it is Jesus who brings me into the presence of the Father.

The more I cried out, the more I heard myself praying this prayer:

"Holy Spirit, please help me."

I suppose that as a faith man, you are not supposed to beg, but I can remember begging.

"Please, Holy Spirit. Your ministry is to glorify Jesus in me. Who but You can teach me how to offer my soul in worship?"

I had to find out what my soul consisted of. Of course, it is my mind, my will, my intellect, and my emotions.

What do I contact physical things with? My flesh, my physical man. But with my soul, my mind, will, intellect, and emotions, I make contact with my fellow man. We actually communicate through feelings and accumulated knowledge. Intellectually, through our souls, we make contact

with each other.

But God is a Spirit. He must be contacted with my spirit. Jesus said those who worship Him must worship Him in spirit and in truth.

Now I am asking the Holy Spirit to help me present my soul in worship, the part of me with which I make contact with my fellow man: my reasonings, my mind, my feelings, my intellect. I want to know how to get past the brazen altar and offer my soul in worship to Him.

What He began to teach me was amazing.

In Matthew 6, when Jesus said, "Do not be as the hypocrites," He spoke to me and said, "The same way I am teaching you to enter the presence of your Father is how you need to enter into My presence."

First of all, do not be as the hypocrites. They love to pray standing in the synagogues and on the street corners to be seen of men. In other words, if there were no one to see them, they would not have a prayer life.

You know how much I am for public services and corporate worship, especially when people know how to give their all and pour themselves into worship, into every statement of adoration that every phrase of a song brings. But in public worship, music provides the emotion. Pretty soon your foot is tapping. The lyrics provide what you need to fill your mind with. So we can stand there hating the person next to us and still be seen of men as though we are worshipping God.

Jesus said, "First of all, do not be as the hypocrites."

How much respect do you think you are showing your King when the only part of you in that worship service is your mouth, while the rest of you is walking down the street somewhere?

Jesus is my best friend because He knows me better than anyone. He is my confidant. He is my ever-present help in time of need. He is the One who gave me the use of His name when I present my petition to the Father.

But when I am getting ready to present that petition, He is my King and my Priest. I am going to treat Him with the same kind of respect in protocol that an ambassador gives when entering the presence of a king. Every king from every country has different protocol. One will not let you look up until he tells you that you can. Another requires an expensive gift. But all have some kind of protocol.

I am not going to do my High Priest and my King the disrespect, in public or private worship, of walking into His presence with my soul wandering down the street while my mouth stands there telling Him how much I love Him.

So I said, "Holy Spirit, please help me. Teach me how to offer my soul in worship."

When I entered His presence, He said, "I do not want your mind off somewhere solving a problem. I do not want your will switching you over into something else. I do not want your emotions going somewhere and exploring something else while you are in My presence."

When I first entered His presence to give all of myself into each statement of adoration, I do not mind telling you, it was rough. I did not know how thick the veil of my flesh was. I felt like a little tin soldier at the end of a tunnel. Every statement I made, "I love You; I glorify You," seemed to come out of my mouth and fall on the ground, as if I were the only one in the whole universe.

I would be there a while thinking I was doing pretty well. Then I would come to myself about thirty minutes later and realize the only part making noise was my mouth. The rest of me had wandered off somewhere and was doing something else.

I decided I would not do Him the disrespect of being there only with my body while the part of me I wanted to offer in worship was somewhere else down the street. I would stop, collect all the attributes of my soul back together, and empty them into each statement of adoration.

Follow me closely.

Jesus is glad that devils are subject to you in His name: disease, poverty, and every other thing He has delivered you from. But in His instructions, He said, "Rejoice rather that your names are written in heaven."

When He taught me private worship, I found that the best kind of worship to my King was me to Him. He said, "I am glad you are glad that devils are subject to you. But Son, do you know what I am glad about? I am glad that your name is written in heaven and that you are going to spend forever with Me. How about getting to know Me now?"

Most of the worship He taught me in those hours took the path of me to Him. It was statements of adoration about how much I loved Him.

It is not the multitude of statements you come up with. It is not how loud or how quiet you worship Him. It is how much of your soul you pour into each statement of adoration.

That is training.

Now I can sit back in the chair in my office, put my feet on the recliner, and before my mind gets away from me, I can fall into worship. The Holy Ghost rises up and baptizes my mind in that worship. I do not have to think of anything. I get lost in His presence. After a while He gets me by the arm and says, "The Holy Spirit has turned you over to Me. I am going to take you past the brazen altar and the veil of the flesh. We are going into the Holy of Holies, and I am going to turn you over to the Father. You worship Him a while."

In the beginning, I only had a few statements. I am a Word-of-Faith man, full of the Word, but I only had a few statements:

"I love You. I worship You. I glorify You. I magnify You. I love You, Jesus."

Those were me to Him.

I could think of thousands of statements like, "I thank You for healing me. I thank You for blessing me." Those were about what He did to me and for me. But I only had a few statements that were I to You.

I would rather repeat three or four statements of adoration in worship, pouring my whole self into them, than try to think of many words that sound good in His ears.

So here I go:

"I love You. I really love You. I really worship You. I worship You. I glorify You. I magnify You. I love You, Jesus. I love You and praise You and glorify You."

Once in a while I would go onto this path:

"I bless the day that I was born again. I bless the day that You saved me. I worship You. I glorify You."

Then I would find my soul walking off down the street. But I would catch it earlier and pull it back in. I did not care how long it took to collect the attributes of my soul together. I would pour them back into every statement of adoration until He came.

Sometimes God comes by His mercy and touches us in worship so we do not forget what it is like. People run out and say, "My God, that was a good worship service. He really moved. He sovereignly took us into worship."

But worship is not supposed to be sovereign anymore than the flow of His miracles through a crowd on Sunday morning is supposed to be sovereign. There is a way to step through the veil of the flesh and enter His presence in worship. As you collect your soul back together and continue to offer it, the time it takes to collect your soul becomes shorter and shorter. So does the time it takes to step through the veil of the flesh into the Holy of Holies where His presence is.

I am approaching the Godhead with this petition. I want to see a thousand born again every week from the families of the prayer center. That is not asking much. I want people's new natures to so dominate their souls that they can get along with one another. And I want to find out in worship how to step through the veil of the flesh into His presence, where He sustains us in the temporary realms of the soul while He works permanency of character in us.

I have petitions. Yes.

It is the Holy Spirit who glorifies Jesus in me. He leads me into Jesus' presence. Then it is Jesus who brings me into the presence of the Father.

God forbid that I would rush past Jesus with a petition without stopping at His feet to worship.

Go to John 16:23:

And in that day ye shall ask me nothing.
Verily, verily, I say unto you,
Whatsoever ye shall ask the Father in my name, he will give it you.

He is talking about our day, this covenant. Up until that time, Jesus did most of the apostles' praying for them. When they had a need or somebody needed prayer, He prayed for them. But He is speaking of our covenant:

In that day ye shall ask me nothing.

He said:

Hitherto have ye asked nothing in my name:
ask, and ye shall receive,
that your joy may be full.

Does it seem to matter how good the teachers are or how good the pastors are? When they are done, sometimes you are left with a thirst that only entering into fellowship with the Father can quench. Nobody can help it. No matter how good they are, even if they are the best in the world, you still walk out hungry.

When the ministry is consuming you for fellowship, when you want to see miracles and want to be used by God so badly, we could feed you filet mignon every Sunday from this pulpit and it could not be any better. But you would rather eat hot dogs if you are the one who gets to fix them.

Jesus said, "Ask, and you shall receive, that your joy may be full." Your joy is full for two reasons: first, because He answered your prayer; second, because you got to do the asking.

Verse 25:

These things have I spoken unto you in proverbs:
but the time cometh, when I shall no more speak unto you in proverbs,
but I shall shew you plainly of the Father.

Verse 26:

At that day ye shall ask in my name:
and I say not unto you, that I will pray the Father for you:
For the Father himself loveth you,
because ye have loved me.

The Father Himself loves you. Why? Because you have loved Jesus.

One more time: I am approaching the Godhead with a petition. God forbid that I would pass by Jesus on my way to the Father without stopping at His feet to worship Him.

Jesus said that whatever you ask the Father in His name, He will give it to you. Why? Because you have loved Jesus. The reason the Father hears and answers is because I have loved Jesus.

This part almost escapes me. It is hard for me to understand agape. As human beings, we operate in it only in little spurts. I know that when the love of God manifests, it is in compassion. I am trying to understand a love that can take two paths, one of judgment and one of mercy, and when it takes judgment, even that is usually mercy. When Paul turned a man over to Satan for the destruction of the flesh so his spirit would be saved in the day of the Lord, that was compassion. That was the love of God manifested in judgment. Now that man is happy because he has been in heaven two thousand years instead of under your feet.

If I ever got off like that, I pray to God you would get together and do whatever was necessary if it caused me to be saved.

The Father Himself hears you, loves you, and answers your prayer because you love Jesus. God is so much in love with human beings that He loves you for loving the One who put you back into fellowship with Him.

But we have made such a ritual out of prayer that we just walk into God's presence and say, "Oh, and by the way, I need a new car. In Jesus' name."

In emergency situations, you do not have time. Somebody brings a crisis, and we pray to the Father in the name of Jesus. He knows all of that. But when you have a petition for the lost, or something you need to change, and you have time to go into the presence of the Father, then enter Jesus' presence with respect. Stop at His feet and worship Him. Let the Holy Spirit turn you over to Him, and then let Jesus bring you into the presence of the Father.

Amen.

The Lord wanted me to spend most of the time tonight in protocol. For fifteen or twenty minutes, we are going to enter into protocol and ask the Holy Spirit to help us turn ourselves over to Him in worship.

I want you to select somebody who is lost, someone to call out to God for when we go into petitionary prayer. Tonight we are going to major on entering into Jesus' presence. We will spend a little time with the Father, but mostly we will enter His presence to present the petition.

Amen.

We are going to do this just as we would do private worship. We are going to pull the words from our own inner sanctuary. We are not going to have worship leading. We are going to stand for the next fifteen or twenty minutes. Standing or sitting is not the issue; if you get tired, sit down. Make

yourself comfortable. It is where your spirit is flowing.

Remember protocol. If you find yourself wandering off down the street, come back. Collect your soul back together and empty it into every statement of adoration. If your pauses have to be thirty seconds while you collect yourself, then let them be thirty seconds. In each statement of worship, pour yourself into it.

After fifteen or twenty minutes, we will pray the Lord's Prayer and present our petition.

Amen.

When we reach into our own inner sanctuary, the Holy of Holies, and choose our own words, music will not be doing it for us. Lyrics will not be filling our heads for us. It is just us and Him.

Stand up. Hallelujah, Jesus.

I am going to lead you for a while. Remember, it is not how loud or quiet you are. It is how much of yourself you are giving.

Many times, if we let the soul wander around and come back on its own, it can take a long time to enter worship. But if you offer your soul as a living sacrifice, if you do it, your time of entering His presence will become shorter and shorter. I find myself lapsing into it at the strangest times. I am not even paying attention, and the next minute I hear myself worshiping God because I slipped in as an involuntary act and did not realize I had done it.

"I thank You. I love You. I glorify You. I worship You, Jesus. I magnify You and bless Your holy name."

It is not how loud. It is not how quiet. It is how much you pour. When you get excited, it may get louder. Some people get quieter. The bottom line is that it really does not make any difference. What would Jesus say? He would say, "What is that to you? You worship Me."

Amen.

I will lead you for a little while, leave you to worship Him yourself for a while, then come back when it is time to present a petition.

Holy Spirit, I desire again tonight that You teach me how to offer my soul in worship. Anything new You can teach me tonight about it, I would appreciate it. Teach me how to yield myself more quickly into Your presence.

"I worship You and glorify You and exalt You and extol You, my Jesus. I love You. I worship You and glorify You. Hallelujah, Jesus. I love You, Jesus. I love You and worship You and magnify You. I bless the day that You saved me."

One reason it is so much easier just to flow in tongues is that it leaves your mind out. Your mind is free to wander around from time to time. But now, in worship and the offering of your soul in the presence of my King, you need to offer all of it. Your flesh will get thick for a while and resist you,

but go on. What is that to you?

Somebody is standing next to you? What is that to you? You are entering the presence of the King of Kings. Show some respect.

"I worship You, Jesus. I love You and adore You and magnify You. I love You, Jesus. I worship You, Jesus. I love You, Jesus. I worship You, Jesus. I magnify You. Hallelujah. I bless the day that You saved me."

He already knows what is in my petition. I know that He knows what is in it. So I am entering His presence and worshiping and praising Him for what He has done for me.

If it were not for Your name and Your blood, there would be no entry into the presence of the Father. So I would like to tell You, Jesus, ten thousand times how much I have fallen in love with You.

"Jesus, I have fallen in love with You. I glorify You and love You and magnify You and praise You. I bless the day that You saved me. I bless the day I could call You my Lord. Jesus, I want to take these minutes to tell You how much I love You. I worship You. I love You."

Do not let the flesh whip you. Come on.

"I glorify You and magnify You, Jesus. I worship You and adore You. Thank You, Holy Spirit, for helping me. Words fail me, but I love You, Jesus. I worship You and glorify You. I praise You and magnify You. I bless You and adore You."

I would like to stand here for an hour and tell You how much I love You, Jesus.

Help me, Holy Spirit. Help me to offer my soul. I want to know how to do it. I want to know how to offer respect to my King, my Savior, my High Priest, my Jesus.

Some of you are finding out how thick that flesh is.

"I love You, Jesus. I worship You and praise You and glorify You. I magnify You. I extol You. I exalt You. I bless You, Jesus."

Some of you are getting lost in it. Go on. Enter the inner sanctuary of your own Holy of Holies. You go on and finish offering your soul in worship.

Hallelujah, Jesus.